

SHED
COMICS

VOL. 1
EPISODE 01

PRIMAL

SEASON ONE



EP01 SCN06
THE CITY OF A THOUSAND SPIRES

CONCORDANCE SPIRES.
A MEGA-METROPOLIS
THAT PIERCES THE CLOUDS
AND DROWNS THE SUN.

FIVE HUNDRED DISTRICTS.
MILLIONS OF LIVES.
ENDLESS CONNECTIONS.
ENDLESS RISKS.

DISTRICTS OF CONCORDANCE SPIRES

PARADISE DISTRICT

INDUSTRIAL STACKS

LUMINANCE CORE

THE RUSTWAY

THE HEIGHTS

BEFORE THE RESCUE...

THE WIND
SUDDENLY—!

WHAT'S
HAPPENING?!

WHOOOOSH!!

C-CONTROL
SPIRES NOT
RESPONDING!

MANUAL
OVERRIDE!
NOW!

LINE 8!
MANUAL
OVERRIDE
ENGAGED!

KRRRIIIKK!!

THE CABLE—
IT CAN'T HOLD
US!

SOMETHING BIGGER
THAN THE WIND.
SOMETHING OLDER
THAN THE SPIRES.

SOMETHING
HAS HEARD.

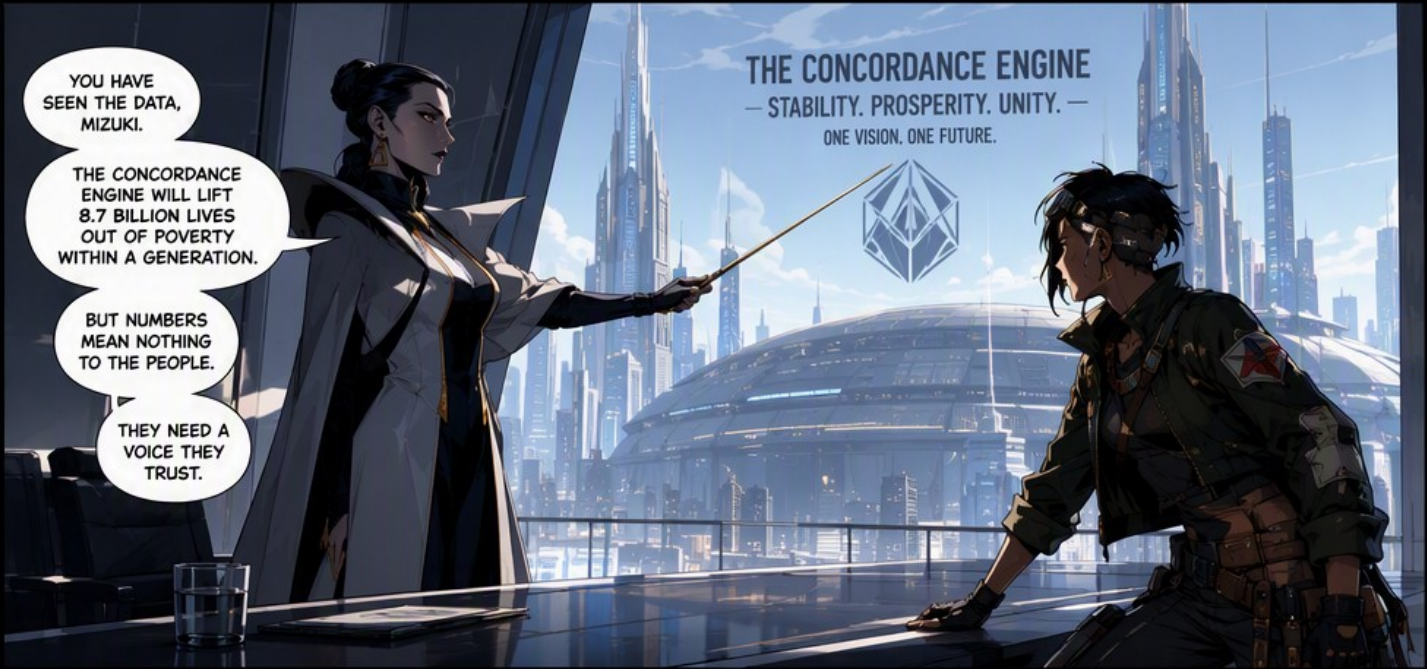
AND IT IS
COMING.





EP01 SCN09
A WALK INTO THE WONDER





THE CONCORDANCE ENGINE
— STABILITY. PROSPERITY. UNITY. —
ONE VISION. ONE FUTURE.

YOU HAVE
SEEN THE DATA,
MIZUKI.

THE CONCORDANCE
ENGINE WILL LIFT
8.7 BILLION LIVES
OUT OF POVERTY
WITHIN A GENERATION.

BUT NUMBERS
MEAN NOTHING
TO THE PEOPLE.

THEY NEED A
VOICE THEY
TRUST.



THAT VOICE
IS YOURS.

A PUBLIC
ENDORSEMENT.

ONE SPEECH.
ONE VOTE CAST
IN THE FORUM.

AND YOU BECOME
THE BRIDGE BETWEEN
THE GRID AND THE
GROUND.



AND IF
I REFUSE?



THEN THE ENGINE
WILL STILL LAUNCH.

WITHOUT YOU.

AND THE NARRATIVE
WILL BE WRITTEN
BY THOSE WHO
ENVER LEFT THE
GROUND TO SEE
THE TRUTH.



THAT'S NOT
A CHOICE.

THAT'S A
THREAT.



IT'S
REALITY.

MIZUKI, I DIDN'T
CLIMB TO MINISTER
BY BELIEVING IN
FAIRY TALES.

I CLIMBED BY
UNDERSTANDING
THAT CIVILIZATIONS
DON'T FALL TO
ENEMIES.

THEY FALL TO
SYSTEMS THAT
CAN'T FEED THEM.



AND YOU
WANT ME TO
PRETEND THIS
SYSTEM DOESN'T
FEED ON US?

I'VE SEEN WHAT
THE CONCORDANCE
DOES TO PLACES
THAT RESIST.

I WON'T BE
YOUR POSTER
GIRL.



THEN DON'T
BE A POSTER
GIRL.

BE A
FAULT LINE.

GIVE THEM
A REASON TO
LISTEN.



STAND IN THAT
FORUM. LOOK THEM
IN THE EYES.

TELL THEM
WHAT YOU SAW.

CONCORDANCE
VOTE INITIATION
CYCLE 77-A

THEN CAST
YOUR VOTE.

MAKE IT
YOURS.



...AND IF
I STILL SAY
NO?

THEN YOU'LL
HAVE CHOSEN
YOUR SIDE.



HISTORY DOESN'T
FORGIVE HEROES,
MIZUKI.

IT FORGIVES
SURVIVORS.

HELP ME KEEP
THEM BOTH ALIVE.

THE CITY IS BUILT
IN LAYERS.

ABOVE, THE UPPER
PLATES—CLEAN,
ORDERED, AND
BRIGHT.

BELOW, THE
UNDER-PLATES—
CRAMPED, LOUD,
AND FORGOTTEN.

IN BETWEEN—
SHAFTS, CABLES,
AND MAINTENANCE
WAYS—BELONG TO
THE PRIMALS.

YOUR PLATE
DEFINES YOUR
LIFE.

CLIMB TOO HIGH
WITHOUT PAPERS,
AND YOU DON'T COME
BACK.

STAY TOO LOW,
AND YOU NEVER
GET A CHANCE
TO LEAVE.

THE SYSTEM
KEEPS
EVERYONE IN
THEIR PLACE.

THAT'S THE
POINT.

BUT EVERY SYSTEM
HAS CRACKS.

AND
SOMEONE
IS GOING TO
FIND THEM.

THE SUB-LEVEL
BLACK MARKET.
YOU CAN FIND
ANYTHING HERE...
IF YOU KNOW
WHO TO ASK.



FROM SPARE
PARTS TO ILLEGAL
UPGRADES...



...TO QUESTIONABLE
SUBSTANCES AND
QUESTIONABLE
ADVICE.



PRIMALS
AREN'T JUST
MUSCLE.



THEY'RE FAMILY.
PROTECTORS.
FRIENDS.



DOWN HERE,
EVERYBODY KNOWS
EVERYBODY.





VEYRA ASCENDANT.

Built to be seen.

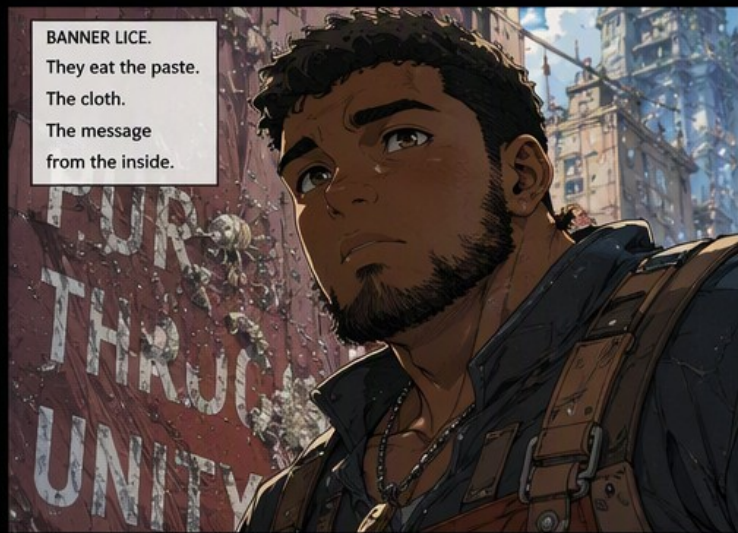
Every wall
a statement.
Every face
an audience.

LOOKS LIKE
THEY'VE BEEN AT
THIS ONE A WHILE.



BANNER LICE.

They eat the paste.
The cloth.
The message
from the inside.



CONCORDANCE STAGING HANGAR
THREE DAYS UNTIL DEMONSTRATION

THEY DON'T CALL IT
"TRUTH MANAGEMENT"
BECAUSE IT'S HONEST.

IT TOOK
FORTY PEOPLE
TO HANG THIS!

BISCUIT!
NOT NOW!

SENSORIAL
CONDITIONING
—DO NOT
REMOVE—

UH-OH.

THAT'S
NOT A SPARK.
THAT'S A BAD
SPARK.

TZZT!

POMFFFFRRBBLLLL!

BWAAAA!

BANNER LICE.
(PSOCOPTERA PAPERINUS)
FEED ON STARCH AND
ORGANIC PASTES.

HARMLESS TO HUMANS.
INDICATORS OF CHEMICAL
TREATMENT.

ARE YOU
KIDDING ME?!

WE JUST
TREATED
THOSE
YESTERDAY!

NO.
THEY'RE
NOT ON ALL OF
THEM.

LOOK—THEY'RE
AVOIDING THESE
PANELS.

THE ONES
TREATED WITH
SUBSONIC
INHIBITORS.

THE LICE WON'T
TOUCH THEM.

SUBSONIC INHIBITORS...
DELIVERED THROUGH
BANNER PULP.

ABSORBED THROUGH
THE PRIMAL'S SKIN.
NO NEEDLES.

NO RESISTANCE.

YOU'RE NOT
JUST STAGING
A MESSAGE...

YOU'RE
DOSING AN
ENTIRE
SPECIES.

I COOK
FOR PRIMALS.

I KNOW
WHEN FOOD'S
POISONED.

THIS ISN'T
FOOD.

IT'S A
LEASH.

BIS...
CUIT?

FIRST, THEY HELPED ME HANG
THE LIE. NOW, THEY HELP ME
TEAR IT DOWN.

ACCOUNTABILITY IS
EXPENSIVE. TRUTH IS WORSE.

EP01 SCN04
THE CONTINENTAL
FREIGHT YARDS



TO BE CONTINUED...

THE GENERATOR PARK.

A PLACE THAT BLEEDS OFF EXCESS POWER... AND FEEDS DREAMS IN RETURN.



LIGHTS, RIDES, ARCADES... ALL SPUN BY OUR PRIMAL ENERGY!



AND BY PRIMALS WHO DON'T GET ENOUGH SLEEP.



HEY, LOOK. THE FERRIS WHEEL JUST WOKE UP.



YUP.



PRIMAL:
WHEEL-ON-NINE.
MOOD: HYPED.



PRIMAL:
VOLT VIPER.
MOOD: UNHINGED.



YOU'RE TERRIBLE. THAT'S WHY WE LOVE HIM.

PRIMAL: BUTTON MASHER.
MOOD: HOPELESS.

DEEP BELOW, THE GENERATORS NEVER STOP.

THEY GRUMBLE. THEY SPARK. THEY DREAM TOO.



POWER ISN'T JUST MADE.



IT'S PLAYED WITH.

TOMORROW, WE MAKE IT BIGGER.

AND LOUDER.



HEH. LET'S SHOCK THE WORLD.

THE CALLING IS
NOT DIVINE.
IT IS OPTICAL.

A CHAOS OF
REFRACTION AND
EXPECTATION.

I WILL
STANDARDIZE
IT. I WILL
CONTROL IT.

I WILL
SAVE THEM
FROM
THEMSELVES.

THE CONCORDANCE FORUM.
POPULATION: 100,000 SOULS.

TODAY'S OBSERVANCE:
THE CALLING OF THE STAG.

BEHOLD
THE LIGHT
OF THE
STAG!

THE CALLING!
THE CALLING!

BLESSED
BE THE
CHOSEN!

MAY THE
STAG GUIDE
HIS WILL!

ANGLE.
INTENSITY.
POLARIZATION.
HUMAN BELIEF IS
SO EASILY
DIRECTED.

A MIRACLE
IS JUST A
CALIBRATED
ILLUSION.

AND I—
I AM ITS
ARCHITECT.

The Underforum Resonance Works

Depth: Below Veyra Ascendant

Acoustic Layer: Shed-Laminate 7

PRISTINE
ABOVE.

FILTHY,
LOUD,
UGLY
BELOW.

ARTIFICIAL
FREQUENCY
BROADCAST
FIELD.

TUNING CRANE
FEATHER-REED:
MAPPING RESONANCE
HARMONICS.

THIS PLACE
SHOULDN'T
EXIST.

OF COURSE
IT DOES.
SOMETHING
HAS TO
MAKE THE
MIRACLES
HAPPEN.

MIRACLES ARE
JUST WELL-TUNED
LIES WITH BETTER
ACOUSTICS.

HRRMM?

INTERFERENCE
IS SEVERE.
DIRECTIONAL
SENSE: 73%
DEVIATION AND
RISING.

THE DIVINE
DOESN'T SPEAK
FROM HEAVEN.

IT'S PAID FOR,
AMPLIFIED,
AND MAINTAINED.

DOWN HERE.

UNDERFORUM.
CONCORDANCE ENGINE
CENTRAL NEXUS / RESONANCE CONTROL

YOUR LIGHTS
FIRE THREE SECONDS
BEFORE THE STAG
TURNS.

YOU AREN'T
PREDICTING A
CALLING.

YOU'RE STEERING
AN ANIMAL.



YOU TOOK
MY PRISM.

YOU DON'T
UNDERSTAND WHAT
YOU'RE READING.

THE CALLING ISN'T
A BEAST YOU CAN
LEASH WITH TIMING
AND PHASE.

IT'S WILL.
MYSTERY.

IT'S—

PROFESSOR ARVEN DOR

CHIEF ARCHITECT, CONCORDANCE ENGINE
INVENTOR OF THE DIAGNOSTIC PRISM
BELIEVER IN CONTROL THROUGH
UNDERSTANDING

THEN EXPLAIN
THIS.

EXPLAIN WHY
YOUR "WILL" ALWAYS
FOLLOWS YOUR
LANTERN GRID.

EXPLAIN WHY
THOUSANDS DIE
WHEN YOUR TIMING
SLIPS.

PEOPLE DIE WHEN
THE CALLING IS
IGNORED!

MY ENGINE
SAVES LIVES!

IT GIVES US
PATTERN, ORDER—
A CHANCE!

WITHOUT IT,
WE'RE NOTHING
BUT PREY!

YOU DON'T
SAVE LIVES.

YOU JUST DECIDE
WHICH ONES GET
TO BE OFFERED.



PROFESSOR
ARVEN DOR.

MASTER OF THE
CONCORDANCE
ENGINE.

ARCHITECT OF
ORDER.

BELIEVER IN
ELIMINATION.

HE SEEKS TO
ERADICATE THE
UNPREDICTABLE.

TO SILENCE THE
CALLING.

TO SAVE US
FROM OURSELVES.

HE DOES NOT
UNDERSTAND.



MAXIMUM
CONCORDANCE
OUTPUT.

NOW.



FULL SPECTRUM.
FULL INTENSITY.

NO
RESTRAINTS.



THE PRISM STAG.
A WILD REGISTER.

HABITUATED TO
ARTIFICIAL LIGHT
GARDENS.

NOT MAGIC.

NOT A GOD.

A LIVING BEING.

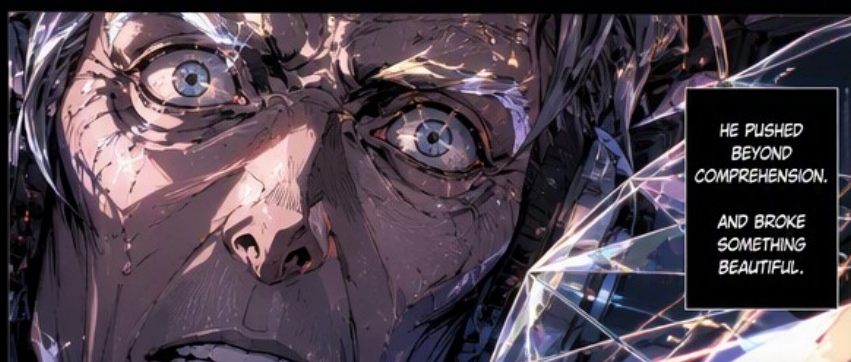
VIGILANT.
EASILY
OVERSTIMULATED.

TRYING TO
INTERPRET
CONTRADICTIONARY
SIGNALS.

TRYING TO
SURVIVE.



THE CROWD.
ONE HUNDRED
THOUSAND SOULS.
BLINDED.
TERRIFIED.
BETRAYED.



HE PUSHED
BEYOND
COMPREHENSION.

AND BROKE
SOMETHING
BEAUTIFUL.

THE CONCORDANCE
FORUM.

THE TOWER WILL
CRUSH THEM.

NOT EVEN THE
SHIELD-CLOAKS CAN
SAVE THEM FROM
THAT WEIGHT.

BUT THE PRISM STAG
DOES NOT RUN.

IT BREAKS
ITS TETHERS.

KRAAANK!

IT CHOOSES.

THE ANTLERS—SEVEN
METERS ACROSS.

KERATIN LAYERS
WOVEN TO REACT
TO SUNLIGHT.

LIGHT ANSWERS.

THE TOWER HITS
LIKE A FALLING MOUNTAIN.

NATURAL LIGHT.

RAW. WILD. FREE.

FOR THE FIRST TIME,
THE FORUM SEES
THIS LIGHT...

WITHOUT THE
ENGINE.





NEON STRIP,
THE PRIMAL CAPITAL
OF THE WORLD.

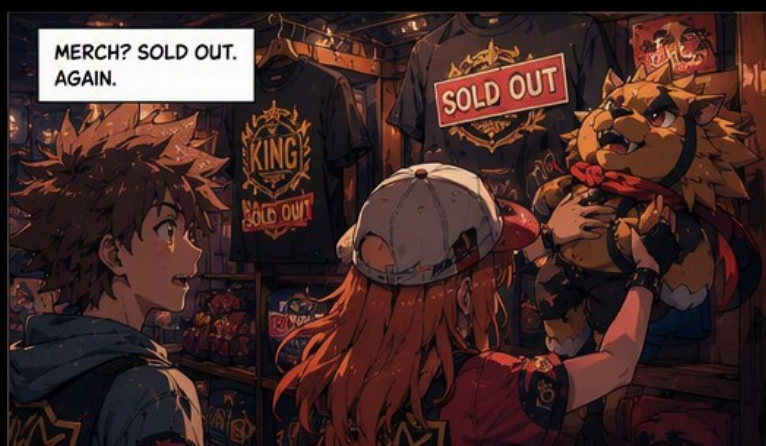


THE COLOSSEUM IS
ALREADY ROCKING.

WOOOOOAAAHH!



FANS COME FROM
EVERYWHERE.



MERCH? SOLD OUT.
AGAIN.

SOLD OUT



AND TONIGHT...
SOMETHING BIGGER
THAN A MATCH.



WHISPERS OF A NEW
CHALLENGER SPREAD
LIKE WILDFIRE.

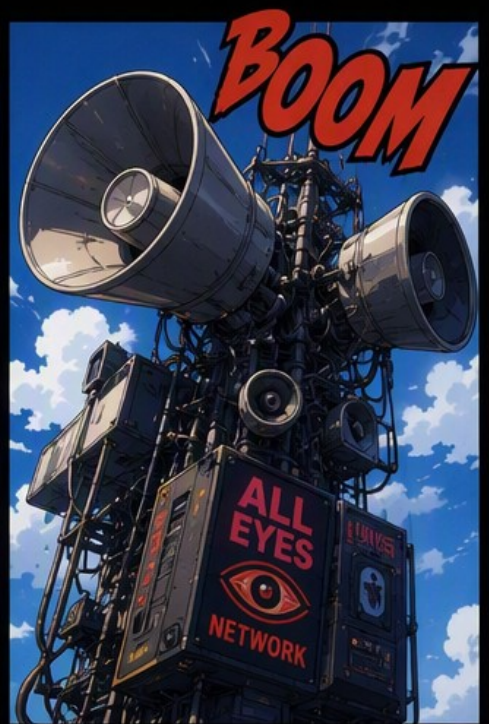
DID YOU HEAR?

SOMETHING
BIG'S
COMING...

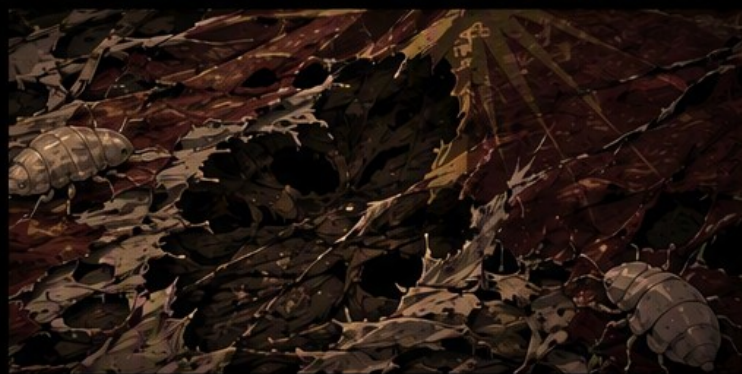


THE CITY HOLDS ITS BREATH.

I CAN'T
WAIT.







THE LIE IS PAPER.
THE BONDS ARE REAL.



THEY DON'T REMEMBER
WHAT THIS PLACE WAS.

ONLY THAT IT KEEPS
THEM SAFE.